

CS112: Friday 4 September, 12:15 to 1:20

DRAFT, RECONSTRUCTED FROM COURSE-MAP.YML AND THE TEACHING LOG

Wednesday ended on `&x`, a number printed in hexadecimal that nobody had explained yet, after types, sizes, uninitialized memory, and the three bases.

Today: memory is numbered boxes, and a pointer holds one of those numbers. Once that is on the board, arrays stop being a separate feature of the language. `a[i]` is not a lookup, it is arithmetic, and the square brackets are shorthand for a calculation you could write yourself.

TIME	BEAT
12:20	1. Address-of and dereference
12:38	2. An array is contiguous
12:55	3. Pointer arithmetic

Beat 1. Address-of and dereference (18 min)

```
int y = 7;
int *p = &y;           // p holds the ADDRESS of y

cout << p << endl;    // 0x7ffd... where y lives
cout << *p << endl;   // 7          what is there
*p = 99;               // change y without naming it
cout << y << endl;    // 99
```

Two symbols, and they are opposites. `&` asks where, `*` asks what is there.

Talk to your neighbor. What does `*y` mean, when `y` is an `int`?

Nothing, and it is a compile error. Dereferencing only makes sense on something that holds an address.

Beat 2. An array is contiguous (17 min)

```
int arr[5] = {10, 20, 30, 40, 50};

cout << arr      << endl;      // an address
cout << &arr[0] << endl;      // the same address
cout << &arr[1] << endl;      // four bytes further on
```

The array's name is the address of its first element. The elements sit in a row with nothing between them, each exactly `sizeof(int)` wide.

Three facts that follow, and all three bite later: the size is fixed, nothing checks your index, and the contents start as garbage.

Beat 3. Pointer arithmetic (15 min)

```
int *ptr = arr;
cout << *(ptr + 1) << endl;    // 20
cout << arr[1]      << endl;    // 20
```

Why does `+ 1` move four bytes and not one?

Because the compiler knows the type, so it counts in elements rather than in bytes. And that is the identity worth writing on the board:

$$a[i] \equiv *(a + i)$$

The brackets are notation. The machine does the addition either way.